

Retail Property Types

Numerous types of shopping centers exist. Typically, classification is based on what types of goods/services are sold and their size.

Listed below are several basic classifications and characteristics, from largest to smallest. This information is a guideline to understanding different types of retail property.

General Purpose Center

Super-Regional Mall

- Typically larger than a regional mall, offering more variety (mega malls).
- Enclosed with inward-facing stores connected by a common walkway. General merchandise and fashion. The parking lot surrounds the perimeter.
- Has more than one anchor that is a full-line department store.
- Trade area is five to 25 miles.

Regional Mall

- A step-down in size from a super-regional mall, offering general merchandise and fashion.
- Typically enclosed with inward-facing stores connected by a common walkway. The parking lot surrounds the perimeter.
- Has one anchor that is a full-line department store.
- Trade area is five to 15 miles.

Neighborhood Center

- A step-up in size from a strip mall, often including dry cleaners, barbershops, fast food, hardware, and convenience stores.
- Typical anchor is a supermarket.
- Trade area is three miles.

Strip Mall/Center or Convenience Mall

- The smallest example listed. Open-air with stores arranged in a row, or in an L or U shape, with a sidewalk and large parking lot in front.
- Usually faces major traffic areas and has an anchor tenant in the center or on one/both ends.
- Typical anchor is a mini mart.
- Trade area is less than one mile.

Specialized Center

Factory Outlet

- Typically even larger than a super-regional mall. It's a specialized shopping center including discounted items from brand named manufacturers.
- Makes up 1% of retail industry. Typically located outside main shopping areas to save on land costs.
- Anchor store is a brand name outlet.
- Trade area is 25 to 75 miles.